DocFlow AI - User Manual

How normal users create requests, upload documents, track approvals, and use OCR/manual correction.

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Project Overview for Users

DocFlow AI is a smart document approval and workflow automation system. It helps an organization create approval requests, upload supporting documents, run AI/OCR text extraction, route approvals through workflow steps, track status, send reminders, and generate reports or certificates.

Who uses this system?

Role	Main Use
Staff	Create draft requests, upload documents, submit requests, track status, correct OCR text if allowed.
Department Head	Review department requests and approve/reject assigned steps.
Approver	Approve, reject, comment, and see approval inbox.
Organization Admin	Manage users, departments, workflows, policies, reports, settings, and monitor all organization requests.
Auditor	View requests, audit logs, reports, and compliance history.
Super Admin	Manage platform organizations and platform users.

Main advantages for users

• Reduces paper-based follow-up and manual tracking.

• Shows clear request status: Draft, Submitted, In Review, Approved, Rejected, or Cancelled.

• Keeps uploaded document history with versioning and rollback.

• Supports OCR for scanned PDFs/images and manual correction.

• Provides notifications, reminders, and approval inbox for fast action.

• Keeps audit history for accountability.

User Login and Dashboard

Users log in from the accounts login page. After login, each role is redirected to its own dashboard. The dashboard shows request counts, pending approvals, recent activity, and quick navigation.

Basic login workflow

1. Open the project URL in browser.

2. Click Login.

3. Enter username/email and password.

4. After login, confirm your dashboard role is correct.

5. Use sidebar menus to open Requests, Approval Inbox, Documents, Reports, Notifications, or Profile.

If login does not work

• Check that the user account is active.

• Ask organization admin to reset your password.

• If organization is inactive, contact platform super admin.

• If you see permission denied, your role may not have access to that page.

How to Create an Approval Request

A request is first saved as Draft. Draft requests can be edited, documents can be uploaded, and the request can be submitted after the required workflow is selected.

1. Go to Requests.
2. Click New Request.
3. Select Department.
4. Select Approval Workflow. If policy engine is configured, workflow may be auto-selected or changed later.
5. Enter title, category, priority, and description.
6. Click Save as Draft.
7. Open the created request detail page.
8. Upload supporting documents.
9. Review extracted text/AI status if required.
10. Click Submit Request.

Important rules

• Only allowed roles can create requests: Organization Admin, Department Head, and Staff.

• Only the creator can edit/delete/upload documents while the request is Draft.

• Submitted requests are locked for editing and document changes.

• A workflow must have at least one step before request submission.

How to Upload and Manage Documents

Documents are attached to requests. Supported files include PDF, JPG, JPEG, PNG, DOC, and DOCX, depending on your settings. PDF text extraction and OCR can run automatically.

1. Open a Draft request.
2. Click Upload Documents.
3. Choose one or multiple files.
4. Click Upload Documents.
5. Open the document detail to view metadata, OCR status, AI summary, extracted text, and risk level.

Document actions

Action	Meaning
View	Open document metadata and extracted text page.
Correct	Manually correct OCR/extracted text.
Versions	View previous versions and compare.
Replace	Replace current file while saving old file as a version.
Delete	Delete document from Draft request.

How Approval Works for Users

After submission, the selected workflow generates approval steps. The first pending step becomes current. Assigned approvers see the item in Approval Inbox.

1. Creator submits the request.
2. System generates approval steps based on workflow.
3. Assigned approver opens Approval Inbox.
4. Approver reviews request details and attached documents.
5. Approver can add comment, approve, or reject.
6. If approved and not final step, request moves to next approver.
7. If final step is approved, request status becomes Approved.
8. If any current approver rejects, request status becomes Rejected.

Tracking status

• Use Request Detail page to see workflow timeline.

• Use Request Timeline to see submitted, approved, rejected, and commented actions.

• Use Notifications for assignment and result messages.

• Use Reports to print or download request summary/certificate.

Manual OCR Text Correction

If scanned PDF or image OCR output is incomplete or incorrect, allowed users can manually correct the extracted text.

1. Open request detail.
2. In Attached Documents table, click Correct.
3. Review text in the correction box.
4. Update wrong words, missing values, dates, and amounts.
5. Click Save Correction.
6. The corrected text becomes the latest extracted text.

Why correction matters

• AI summary uses extracted text.

• Policy engine may use extracted amount/category.

• Reports may include extracted text and risk notes.

• Manual correction improves accuracy for scanned files.